



no information on pricing and global availability of the Desire 400 dual-SIM.

HTC has lately launched quite a few dual-SIM Desire smartphones – Desire 700 dual-SIM, Desire 601 dual-SIM and Desire 501 dual-SIM.

The HTC Desire 501 dual-SIM and new Desire 400 share similar display size. The Desire 501 dual-SIM sports a 4.3-inch (480 × 800 pixels) display, and features 1.15 GHz dual-core NovaThor U8520 processor and runs on Android 4.1 (Jelly Bean) with Sense UI.

SMS to be soon accepted as official documentary proof in govt dealings

People may soon be able to use SMSs as documentary proof with government departments. The government is launching a 'Mobile Seva' service with over 241 applications relating to health, Aadhaar, Education, RTI, and much more.

Launching the 'Mobile Seva' service, Department of Electronics and IT secretary J Satyanarayana said: "Like Railways, we have to bring in a system wherein by showing (transaction) SMS or, whatever be the case (like e-mail), the proof on mobile is accepted as valid document. To increase our reach we need to bring this kind of practice in mobile and e-governance."

India has over 90 crore mobile subscribers and with the launch of this app it will be easy for them to make transactions with various government departments. At present the digitally signed certificates are accepted as valid document and soon an SMS or a communication available on mobile phone will be accepted as valid proof. Joint Secretary at DEITY

Rajendra Kumar stated that the department is ready with digital signature for mobile phones that the government can use in messages that are to be sent to the citizens applying for a service. "We will start allocating digital signature (Public Key Infrastructure) to all government department on board in first quarter of 2014. Government departments can send communication on mobile of citizen seeking service," Kumar said.

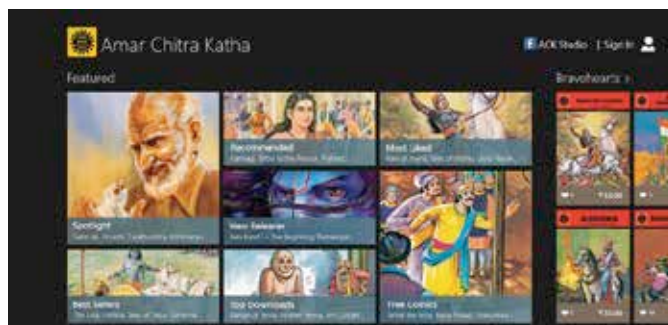
DEITY Additional Secretary Rajiv Gauba stated that about 830 departments from the Centre, state and local authorities have come on board, and the department is working on the third phase to further scale up the mobile governance platform and bring more services under its ambit.

"We have to go through inter-ministerial consultations to scale this m-governance store for launch of third phase. The third phase will have many more departments and capacity to add more services application on this store. Final shape of third phase can be known only after consultation process is complete," he said.

The app is available for Android and Java enabled phones for now. Kumar added that the department is aiming to bring all the applications to HTML5 standard which will make them compatible with all mobile platforms in the next six months.

Apple may launch big screen iPhones and iPads for 2014

According to reports, Apple is prepping a 12.9 inch tablet expected to be launched in October 2014 aimed at North America's educational market. Reports have surfaced following reports from last month citing that Apple's Asia supply chain



Quanta supplier has bagged a contract for mass production a larger sized iPad for late 2014. There are also rumours that Apple is assessing the possibility of ditching the 11 inch MacBook Air with a larger iPad.

Meanwhile, there are also rumours of a larger iPhone, reports have surfaced indicating that Apple is tweaking with a design which has a 4.9 inch display which could debut in 2014. Apple earlier increased the size of the iPhone screen back in 2012, when the iPhone 5 featured a 4 inch screen.

In the meantime, rumours of an iWatch have also surfaced, with Apple planning to release a 1.3 inch and a 1.7 inch display size of the watch for men and women.

As we are well aware of the fact that Apple generally avoids following trends, instead it sets new ones and comes up with new product categories. An iPad with a nearly 13 inch screen could thwart the current trend of smaller tablets and phablets dominating the global market place.

Amar Chitra Katha comics now on Windows 8 app

Amar Chitra Katha Pvt. Ltd. in association with Microsoft India officially introduced 'ACK COMICS', the first digital comic store app of Amar Chitra Katha, exclusively for the Windows 8 platform at Day 1 of Comic Con India, Mumbai, 2013. This app

will let users to browse, purchase and download the titles from Amar Chitra Katha, instantly.

With the launch of ACK Comics app for the Windows 8 platform, the company is planning to have a direct connection and interaction with millions of comic book readers and graphic novel enthusiasts who are ready to dive into an ocean of Indian storytelling.

Speaking at the launch, Vineet Durani, Director of Windows Phone Business Group, Microsoft India, said:

"At Microsoft, we are constantly looking for ways to boost the apps offering and make it more relevant for the consumer. This is yet another step in that direction. Amar Chitra Katha comics are an Indian childhood staple and we are sure consumers will be delighted with the addition of this app to their tablets and notebooks."

Talking about ACK Comics app, it offers more than 200 Amar Chitra Katha's titles to its readers. Five comics including Shakuntala, Birbal the Wise, Tirupati, Tenzing Norgay and Anant Pai will be available free of cost for the first month. As comics are not available FREE to access, it gives readers an option to purchase titles directly within an application. However, readers will be getting three FREE titles, even after the first month. To download the Amar Chitra Katha App for Windows 8 go to <http://dgit.in/ackathw>